

Industry News

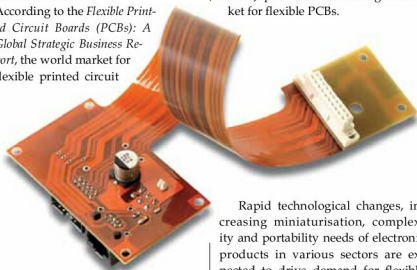
Retail deployments spur RFID

RFID markets worldwide will continue to grow strongly. ABI Research forecasts a total market size of about \$4.6 billion by the end of 2010 for RFID systems (hardware, software and services). The total reaches \$5.5 billion when hardware-only shipments to support automobile immobilisation are included. By the end of 2011, global RFID system markets (excluding immobilisation) are expected to be worth almost \$5.3 billion—a year-on-year growth in excess of 16 per cent. RFID systems software revenue will outpace that from services, transponders and readers.

Massive retail deployment is cited as the key reason for this growth. "Item-level apparel tracking is probably the biggest area to watch in 2010-11 and beyond," the report notes, "especially due to Wal-Mart's jeans and basics tagging announcement." JCPenney, Marks & Spencer and American Apparel among others remain key retailers to watch given their existing programmes and deployment plans.

APAC the largest market for flexible PCBs

According to the *Flexible Printed Circuit Boards (PCBs): A Global Strategic Business Report*, the world market for flexible printed circuit



Flexible printed circuit board

Ghosh joins MMD Philips

Gautam Ghosh has joined MMD Philips, the world's largest monitor manufacturer, as country director for India operations. In this new role, Ghosh will manage all aspects of the India sales and marketing operation and lead Indian management team to drive further growth in the business.

Ghosh will be reporting to Asia Pacific Singapore and will be based out of Delhi. He moves from his current role of country manager for ViewSonic India.

Thirumale is EMC's CTO

EMC Corporation, an information infrastructure solutions provider, has appointed Niranjan Thirumale as chief technology officer (CTO) of the EMC India Center of Excellence (COE). In this role, Thirumale will incubate advanced research and technology development projects within the India COE and raise the technical capabilities of the organisation by working closely with Sarv Saravanan, vice president and managing

boards (PCBs) is likely to exceed \$16 billion by 2015. Asia-Pacific represents the largest as well as the fastest growing market worldwide for flexible PCBs. Japan is the second largest market for flexible PCBs.

Rapid technological changes, increasing miniaturisation, complexity and portability needs of electronic products in various sectors are expected to drive demand for flexible circuits.

In Focus

director, EMC India COE, and other local business unit leaders to further develop the innovative culture within the COE.

Prior to joining India COE, Thirumale had worked at NetApp where he was the founding member and technical leader of its Advanced Technology Group in India and was responsible for driving innovation and long-term vision.

Dell's mobile chief departs

Ron Garriques, the executive in charge of Dell's mobile business, will leave the company at the end of January 2011. Garriques was a high-profile hire when he joined Dell in early 2007, charged with heading a newly created consumer division at the PC maker. He will continue to advise the company for the remainder of the year and be entitled to severance totalling \$1.44 million and an incentive payment of \$368,000.

Dell's communications solutions group, which oversaw the company's smartphone and tablet products, will be broken up and its products folded into other units.

Connectivity critical for growth in handset chips

The total revenue from handset semiconductor shipments is forecast to increase approximately 5.5 per cent this year, says ABI Research. The trend is expected to continue through the next three years, resulting in a total estimated revenue growth of 12 per cent in 2013.

Industry analyst Celia Bo notes, "The increasing shipment rates of handset processors and connectivity chips are the major engines driving handset semiconductor market growth."

Qualcomm, MediaTek and Texas Instruments (TI) are the top players in the overall handset chipset market, accounting for approximately 80 per cent of all shipments. Qualcomm maintains a leading market position, especially in the high-end smartphone